

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, clouds giving way to sun, windy, high 53. **Tonight**, cloudy, diminishing winds early, low 39. **Tomorrow**, clouds, some sun, breezy, high 59. Weather map, Page B12.

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KIANA HAYERI FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

At passport offices, Syrians can check whether their names were included on wanted lists — a status that once filled many with fear.

Syrians Want to Be Wanted by the Assad Regime

By RAJA ABDULRAHIM
ALEPPO, Syria — When he returned to Syria recently for the first time in 12 years, Kazem Togan asked the passport control agent to check whether he “had a name” — meaning that he was among the millions of citizens named on wanted lists under the ousted Assad dictatorship.
“You’re wanted by branch 235,” the man told him, smiling as he delivered the news. “The intelligence branch.”
Mr. Togan, a journalist who worked for opposition Syrian media when the old government was in power, said he was thrilled.

Proud of Being on an Ousted Dictatorship’s Lists of Targets

“Today, every Syrian asks as a matter of routine, ‘Was I wanted?’” he said. “Anyone who was detained by the Assad regime or wanted by the Assad regime, there is a measure of pride.”
For more than five decades, the dictator Bashar al-Assad and his father before him ruled Syria by terror. Anyone wanted by any of the regime’s numerous intelligence, military or security

branches was named on lists that could be checked at airports, border crossings or police stations and risked disappearing into the prison system.
This was known in Syria as “having a name.”
Those who spent their entire lives terrified by the prospect of having a security file are now openly asking officials about their status under the former government and bragging about it openly in conversation or on social media. To have been wanted by a government that tortured or killed millions of its own citizens to hold on to power is a badge of honor —
Continued on Page A6

State No. 51? Not Canada, ‘Captain’ Says.

By VJOSA ISAI
TORONTO — Snow plows rumbled and salt trucks spewed de-icing pellets onto Toronto’s streets, barely visible under two feet of snow. A stocky man brandished a comically small red shovel as he helped dig out a car trapped at an intersection.
The helping hand was provided by Doug Ford, the premier of Ontario, Canada’s most populous province and its largest economy, who came to the rescue of drivers trapped in the January 2022 snowstorm, even giving a few of them rides home.
Some residents criticized the gesture as having the patina of a public relations stunt, but the “little red shovel” moment captured Mr. Ford’s essence: the Everyman who, despite lacking some of the polish of other politicians, still gets the job done.
Mr. Ford has lately been leading the charge against a different kind of storm that has rolled into Canada: President Trump’s threats to the country’s economy and his desire to make it the 51st state.
Mr. Ford, 60, has thrust himself into the public spotlight, aggressively defending Canada’s sovereignty, economy and honor,
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G.O.P. Assault Aims to Hobble The Democrats

Donation Platform and Lawyers Are Targets

By KENNETH P. VOGEL and SHANE GOLDMACHER
Executive actions intended to cripple top Democratic law firms. Investigations of Democratic fund-raising and organizing platforms. Ominous suggestions that nonprofits aligned with Democrats or critical of President Trump should have their tax exemptions revoked.
Mr. Trump and his allies are aggressively attacking the players and machinery that power the left, taking a series of highly partisan official actions that, if successful, will threaten to hobble Democrats’ ability to compete in elections for years to come.
So far, the attacks have been diffuse and sometimes indiscriminate or inaccurate. But inside the administration, there are moves to coordinate and expand the assault.
A small group of White House officials has been working to identify targets and vulnerabilities inside the Democratic ecosystem, taking stock of previous efforts to investigate them, according to two people familiar with the group’s work who requested anonymity to describe it.
Scott Walter, president of the conservative watchdog group Capital Research Center, which monitors liberal money in politics, recently briefed senior White House officials on a variety of donors, nonprofit groups and fund-raising techniques. The White House group is said to be exploring what more can be done within the law.
It is not unusual for partisans in Congress or their outside allies to push for investigations into political groups on the other side of the aisle.
But using the levers of government to target the opposition has long been considered an abuse of power, sometimes leading to prosecution. Mr. Trump himself was impeached in 2019 for pressuring the Ukrainian government to investigate the Bidens.
Mr. Trump’s continued willingness to defy that norm — including in a grievance-filled speech at the Justice Department on Friday, during which he name-checked a litany of critics and called them “horrible people,” “thugs” or “scum” — has Democrats sounding the alarm.
“The breadth is breathtaking,” said Cole Leiter, executive director of Americans Against Government Censorship, a coalition of progressive groups and labor unions created last year to defend against an anticipated Republican assault. Taken together, Mr. Leiter
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PRESIDENT SIGNS ORDER TO SCRAP EDUCATION DEPT.

LEGAL OBSTACLES LOOM

A Separation of Powers Is Clear for an Agency Congress Created

This article is by Michael C. Bender, Erica L. Green and Alan Blinder.
WASHINGTON — President Trump on Thursday instructed Education Secretary Linda McMahon to begin shutting down her agency, a task that cannot be completed without congressional approval and sets the stage for a seismic political and legal battle over the federal government’s role in the nation’s schools.
Surrounded by schoolchildren seated at desks in the East Room of the White House, Mr. Trump signed a long-awaited executive order that he said would begin dismantling the department “once and for all.” The Trump administration has cited poor test scores as a key justification for the move.
“We’re going to shut it down, and shut it down as quickly as possible,” Mr. Trump said.
The department, which manages federal loans for college, tracks student achievement and supports programs for students with disabilities, was created by an act of Congress. That means, according to Article I of the Constitution, that only Congress can shut it down. That clear delineation of power, a fundamental component of democracy from the inception of the United States, underscores why no other modern president has tried to unilaterally shutter a federal department.
But Mr. Trump has already taken significant steps that have limited the agency’s operations and authority. Since Mr. Trump’s inauguration, his administration has slashed the department’s work force by more than half and eliminated \$600 million in grants. The job cuts hit particularly hard at the department’s Office for Civil Rights, which enforces the country’s guarantee that all students have an equal opportunity to an education.
Mr. Trump’s order contains potentially contradictory guidance for Ms. McMahon. On the one hand, the order directs her to facilitate the elimination of the agency. On the other, she is also mandated to rigorously comply with federal law. The order offers no guidance on how to square those two points.
Mr. Trump said Thursday that the department would continue to provide critical functions that are required by law, such as the administration of federal student
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ADRIANNA GLAVIANO FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Treasures of the New Frick
The upgraded museum offers views of “Doge Giovanni Mocenigo,” above, and much more. Page C1.

The Tense Pursuit of the Philippines’ Ex-President

By SUI-LEE WEE and CAMILLE ELEMIA
BANGKOK — The visit had been advertised for weeks. Former President Rodrigo Duterte of the Philippines was going to a rally in Hong Kong during the second weekend in March. But as soon as it began, the trip took on a tantalizing element of intrigue: Was he ever coming back?
To many Filipinos, it appeared that Mr. Duterte was trying to outrun justice. The International

Duterte Unable to Elude International Court

Criminal Court, a sudden swirl of speculation in the Philippines posited, was about to seek his arrest, years after it started investigating the deadly antidrug campaign he had overseen as president and as mayor of Davao. By being in Hong Kong, the theory went, Mr. Duterte would remain free be-

cause China is not a member of the court.
Soon after Mr. Duterte, 79, landed in Hong Kong on March 7, the I.C.C. issued a sealed warrant for him. But wind of the move reached him.
Over that weekend in Hong Kong, his entourage — which included his partner, Honeylet Avanceña, and daughter Sara Duterte, the current vice president — debated whether to stay in Chinese territory or return home,
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Tallow, Panned by Experts, Is Back in the Fryer

By CAROLINE HOPKINS LEGASPI
Will Burgess thinks his French fries taste better now that he fries them in beef tallow. But he isn’t using the animal fat for its taste.
Mr. Burgess, 36, who owns a small restaurant that serves tacos and street food in Middletown, R.I., said he felt a “moral and ethical obligation” to change his menu earlier this year. He came to that conclusion after reading that seed oils, like the canola oil he used to cook his fries and tortilla chips, carried potential harms.
Tallow, he said, made for a healthier, more “natural” frying oil.
Beef tallow, a type of rendered fat, was a staple in America’s home and fast-food kitchens for much of the 20th century before falling out of favor because of its high levels of saturated fat. Now, it’s making a comeback.
In a Fox News segment on March 11, the health secretary, Robert F. Kennedy Jr., celebrated the Midwest-based food chain Steak ‘n Shake for committing to frying its onion rings, chicken tenders and fries in 100 percent



Beef tallow, a type of rendered fat, used to be a kitchen staple.

beef tallow. Upscale grocers stock products like tortilla chips and protein bars made with beef tallow. On social media, influencers render beef tallow in their kitchens, make tallow chocolates and even rub it on their faces.
But doctors and nutrition experts widely agree that using beef tallow in place of vegetable oil is misguided.
Fats like beef tallow (and its pork-based equivalent, lard) were once America’s go-to cooking oils, said Kevin Klatt, a nutrition scientist and dietitian at the University of California, Berkeley.
That started to shift after the introduction of refined vegetable oils in the early 1900s, which were cheaper to mass produce than tallow.
But it wasn’t until the 1980s and 1990s that fast-food chains pivoted to vegetable oils, largely because of new knowledge that diets
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NATIONAL A10-18

Congestion Pricing Reprieve

The Trump administration extended the deadline by 30 days for New York to end its tolling program. PAGE A16

The MetroCard Bows Out

The transition to a tap-and-go system in New York City is set to save the M.T.A. at least \$20 million annually. PAGE A10



INTERNATIONAL A4-9

Sushi Soothes a Frontline Town

For residents of Sloviansk, a Ukrainian city in Russian cross hairs, a popular dish provides a sense of normalcy that is akin to a wartime necessity. PAGE A4

Taming Hungary’s Egg Prices

Prime Minister Viktor Orban is seeking to vanquish inflation, and a political rival, by capping what supermarkets charge for essential foods. PAGE A5

New Round of Fighting in Gaza

Israel’s military expanded its offensive in Gaza with raids in the north and south, and Hamas fired rockets at Israel for the first time in months. PAGE A7

BUSINESS B1-6

A Top Musk Lieutenant

Elon Musk has likened his acolyte at the Department of Government Efficiency to chemotherapy: lifesaving or lethal, depending on the dose. PAGE B1

Fed’s Job Might Get Tougher

President Trump’s plans risk stoking inflation and denting growth, an undesirable combination. PAGE B1

OBITUARIES A19, 22

Maverick in Architecture

David Sellers believed architects could design better buildings if they built them themselves. He was 86. PAGE A22

SPORTS B7-12

Referees Lagging Behind

Women’s basketball is more popular than ever, but one referee said the officiating was at “a crisis moment.” PAGE B7

I.O.C. Elects Woman in a First

Kristy Coventry, below left, a former Olympic swimming champion, faces a raft of urgent issues. PAGE B12



WEEKEND ARTS C1-10

It’s Beethoven to the Rescue

When a star dropped out of an orchestra’s Carnegie Hall performance, a classic substitute was needed. PAGE C1

In a Dark but Tuneful Future

Sadie Sink, of “Stranger Things” fame, plays a talented teenager in “O’Dessa,” a postapocalyptic musical. PAGE C4

OPINION A20-21

Julius Krein

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